

Advanced Chama Management System

Administrator Guide

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Administrator Guide

Advanced Chama Management System – For Super Admin and Admin users.

1. Roles and Responsibilities

As an administrator, you have full access to all system features. Your responsibilities include:

- User management – Creating and managing user accounts
 - System settings – Configuring application behaviour
 - Security – Monitoring audit logs and managing permissions
 - Backup – Ensuring data is backed up regularly
 - Role management – Assigning roles to users
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2. Managing Users

2.1 Creating a User

1. Go to System > Users in the sidebar.
2. Click "Add User".
3. Fill in:
 - Username – Unique login name (required)
 - Email – Unique email address (required)
 - Role – Select from available roles (required)
 - Password – Leave blank to use the default (Admin@123)
 - Phone – Contact number
 - Group Code – The user's chama group code
4. Click "Save User".

2.2 Editing a User

1. Click the edit icon next to the user.
2. Update fields as needed. Leave password blank to keep the current password.
3. Click "Save".

2.3 Suspending/Activating a User

- Click the toggle status button to suspend or activate a user account.
- Suspended users cannot log in.

2.4 Available Roles

ID	Role	Description
1	Super Admin	Full system access
2	Admin	System administrator
3	Chairperson	Group leader
4	Secretary	Records keeper
5	Treasurer	Finance manager
6	Loan Officer	Loan management
7	Member	Regular member
8	Auditor	Financial reviewer

3. System Settings

3.1 General Settings

Go to System > Settings > General to configure:

- Site Name â€” Changes the browser title
- Site Tagline â€” Subtitle displayed on the login page
- Currency â€” Affects how all monetary values are displayed
- Currency Symbol â€” The symbol placed before amounts
- Timezone â€” Affects all date/time displays
- Date Format â€” How dates appear throughout the system

3.2 Branding

Go to Settings > Branding to customise:

- Primary Color â€” Main navigation and heading colour (default: #161950)
- Secondary Color â€” Button and accent colour (default: #465fff)
- Logo â€” Upload a logo image (appears on login page)
- Favicon â€” Upload a browser tab icon

3.3 Security

Go to Settings > Security to configure:

- Max Login Attempts â€” Failed attempts before account lockout (default: 5)
- Session Timeout â€” Minutes of inactivity before auto-logout (default: 60)
- Password Min Length â€” Minimum password length (default: 8)

3.4 Email (SMTP)

Go to Settings > Email to enter mail server details. Note: email sending is not currently functional even with valid SMTP settings.

3.5 Backup

Go to Settings > Backup:

- Toggle Auto Backup on/off
 - Set Backup Frequency (daily/weekly/monthly)
 - Click "Run Manual Backup" to create an immediate SQL backup
 - Backup files appear in a list below the settings form
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4. Managing Loan Products

1. Go to Loans > Loan Products in the sidebar.
 2. Click "Add Product".
 3. Configure:
 - Name â€” Product name (e.g., "Emergency Loan")
 - Interest Rate â€” Percentage (e.g., 5.00)
 - Interest Type â€” Flat or Reducing
 - Max/Min Amount â€” Loan amount limits
 - Max Tenure â€” Maximum repayment period in months
 - Late Penalty â€” Penalty percentage for late payments
 - Grace Period â€” Days before a payment is considered late
 - Processing Fee â€” Percentage charged upfront
 - Description â€” Terms and conditions
 - Requirements â€” Documents or conditions for eligibility
 4. Click "Save".
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5. Managing Contribution Types

Contribution types are created directly in the database. To add a new type, insert a row into the `contribution_types` table with:

- name â€” Display name (e.g., "Monthly Savings")
 - slug â€” URL-friendly name (e.g., "monthly_savings")
 - frequency â€” daily, weekly, monthly, quarterly, yearly, or custom
 - amount â€” Default amount
 - status â€” active or inactive
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6. Monitoring Audit Logs

1. Go to System > Audit Logs in the sidebar.
2. Use filters:
 - Action â€” Create, Update, Delete, Login, Logout, Export, Approve, Reject, Disburse
 - Table â€” The database table that was changed

- User â€” Filter by user ID
 - Date Range â€” Start and end dates
3. The log shows:
 - User â€” Who made the change
 - Action â€” What was done
 - Table â€” Which table was affected
 - Record ID â€” Which record was changed
 - Description â€” Summary of the change
 - IP Address â€” Where the change was made from
 - Date â€” When it happened
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7. Database Backup and Restore

7.1 Manual Backup (via Settings)

1. Go to Settings > Backup.
2. Click "Run Manual Backup".
3. The system creates a complete SQL dump of the database.
4. The backup file appears in the backup list with timestamp and size.

7.2 Restore

The system does not include a restore interface. To restore from a backup:

1. Open phpMyAdmin (<http://localhost/phpmyadmin>).
2. Select the chama_system database.
3. Click the "Import" tab.
4. Choose the backup SQL file.
5. Click "Go" to execute the restore.

7.3 Manual Backup via phpMyAdmin

1. Open phpMyAdmin.
 2. Select the chama_system database.
 3. Click the "Export" tab.
 4. Choose "Quick" method and SQL format.
 5. Click "Go" to download the backup.
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8. Security Best Practices

- Change the default admin password immediately after installation.
- Use strong passwords (12+ characters with mixed case, numbers, and symbols).
- Regularly review the Audit Logs for suspicious activity.
- Keep the server and PHP version up to date.

- Restrict access to the config/database.php file (contains database credentials).
 - Enable HTTPS on the production server.
 - Schedule regular database backups (use the backup frequency setting).
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9. Initial Setup Checklist

- ☐ Import database/sql/schema.sql to create all tables
- ☐ Import database/sql/seed.sql for demo data
- ☐ Log in with admin@chama.com / Admin@123 / CHAMA001
- ☐ Change the admin password
- ☐ Configure Settings > General (site name, currency, timezone)
- ☐ Configure Settings > Branding (colours, logo)
- ☐ Configure Settings > Security (login attempts, timeout)
- ☐ Create user accounts for all group officers
- ☐ Review and create Loan Products as needed
- ☐ Add members through Members page
- ☐ Run a manual backup and verify the file was created